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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Thursday, January 15, 2026

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[00:00:52] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:01:50] Chamber.

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[00:03:04] Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:06:16] Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:07:13] Chamber.

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[00:09:22] Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:11:20] Senate Chamber.

[00:11:29] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

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[00:15:40] Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:17:44] Chamber.

[00:17:45] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:20:50] Chamber.

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[00:21:58] Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[00:24:03] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[00:28:58] The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:29:27] The Senate will come to order. The Senators will take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privilege of the floor will please retire to the gallery.

[00:29:46] Good morning, Senators. Good morning, guests. The Senators and those in the gallery, if you are able, please rise. We will be led in prayer this morning by the Reverend Dr. Cardell C. Patil, Jr., of New Mount Olivet Baptist Church in Portsmouth.

[00:30:15] Following the prayer, if everyone will please remain standing, and we will be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by our Lauren Howard, Journal Assistant in our Senate Clerk's Office.

[00:30:34] Let us pray. Dear God, the source of all being, creator and sustainer of life and hope, we gather in this moment mindful that none of us stands alone, that every decision shaped here echoes beyond these walls into homes, classrooms, and communities across this commonwealth.

[00:30:57] From Bristol to the Allegheny Highlands, from Fairfax down to Portsmouth, we give thanks for the people of Virginia and all of their diversity, for the shared responsibility of shaping a future worthy of them all. Lord, grant those entrusted with public leadership clear minds to weigh complex choices, steady hearts to pursue what is right, and the wisdom to place the common good above personal gain.

[00:31:22] Lord, we ask that the work of this body be guided by fairness and compassion, especially mindful of those whose voices are not present in this chamber. The children who inherit the consequences of today's decisions, the families who look forward to tomorrow with hope, and the communities that depend on wise and thoughtful governance.

[00:31:40] May the policy shape here protect the vulnerable, expand opportunity, and cultivate a commonwealth where every child may grow in safety, dignity, and possibility. Where differences are met with respect, disagreement with civility, and leadership with humility.

[00:31:58] Dear God, may the choices made this day bend toward justice, strengthen trust, and leave a legacy worthy of those who will follow after us. This is our prayer, O Lord. May goodness flourish. Amen. Amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:32:49] Clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye.

[00:33:19] The clerk will close the roll. You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Wednesday, January 14, 2026. The senator from Eastern Enrico, Senator Aird, moves that the reading of the journal be waived.

[00:33:46] All those in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their votes. Aye, those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Does any senator desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 36, noes 3.

[00:34:05] Ayes 36, Nose 3, the reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the House of Delegates. We do not have any, Madam President. The clerk will report any communications from the governor.

[00:34:22] We do not have one, Madam President. Well, we have quickly arrived at that time in our morning hour when we will discover who all of you wonderful people are. And the procedure is that when your senator rises and mentions you, please stand at that time so we'll see you.

[00:34:45] But don't applaud until after I've recognized you. And then we'll all applaud together. So with that, I do now call on Senator Lucas, the senator from Portsmouth. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the Senate, guests seated in the gallery is Reverend Dr. Cardell Petillo.

[00:35:05] As you see on the sheet in front of you, if you have one, He is the pastor of Newmont Olivet Baptist Church. He's a new pastor. And we are so happy to have him about the breakup because he is so active in the community.

[00:35:20] He works with church and community in action. He's a member of the Martin Luther King Junior Leadership Steering Committee. All of the groups in the city that help make people better lives for people. And the thing that I'm so gratified about is he prays for me every day. And so if you would please extend the hand a very warm welcome of the Senate, I would appreciate it.

[00:35:39] - Please stand. Pastor, we're so glad to have you. We're very thankful that you've answered the call. You're a new pastor, and you already know what you're getting into, and it's never easy. And, you know, it reminds me of a Mother Teresa poem, and she said, sometimes the good that you do is throw it in your face, but do good anyway, because it's not between you and them, it's between you and God.

[00:36:04] And sometimes you'll get that, but it'll be all right. You'll keep going, and that's what we need, someone who perseveres. Thank you for coming, and thank you for your prayer. Senators, please welcome him to his Senate. The senator from Bonita, Senator Head.

[00:36:30] Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction. The senator may continue. Thank you, Madam President. We're joining us in the gallery today. We have members from Virginia pro-life. They are coming to us from not only Senate District 3, but from all over the Commonwealth.

[00:36:47] They've been here today visiting in all of our offices, wearing red shirts and wanting to express their opposition some of the amendments that we've got before us today but also wanting to make sure that everyone understands their support for protecting of the unborn.

[00:37:04] They're coming to us from all over as far away as Bristol, Alexandria and Virginia Beach and I hope that it will we'll be able to give them the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you all for coming. Thank you all for making your voices heard. We must hear all voices and we're so glad to see you and I I hope that you continue to come. Senators, please let us give them the warm welcome

[00:37:30] of their Senate. The senior senator from Enrico, Senator Bagby. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for an introduction. The Senator has the floor.

[00:37:53] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the Senate, in the gallery we have medical students from the Commonwealth, from Virginia Commonwealth University who have traveled across Broad Street to visit with us today. We see them walking through these beautiful grounds, headed over to their buildings all the time. It's nice that they chose today to stop by. They've come to speak to us as representatives of the Medical Society of Virginia, advocating for issues related

[00:38:27] to the practice of medicine, including student loan repayment, medical down-coding, non-compete causes clauses and workplace violence. Madam President they seek to make an impact on our Commonwealth well before they graduate and begin to practice medicine and I want the students to know that this body is committed to making Virginia the best place to practice medicine and we hope to see you here for

[00:39:03] long time and hope that we won't we won't have to see you while you're practicing and you will come back and see us while we're practicing and I ask that you grant them a warm welcome in the Senate we are so glad to see you we absolutely need you if you're not there then who will who will be there to care for us and for our future so we are glad that you've gone into the profession we We don't have enough, and I heard the senator say you came from far, just across the street, but you know I have found so many people who are just across the street who have never

[00:39:42] been in their Senate, never been in their House, and to be so close and yet so far. So we're glad that you're here. Senators, let us give them the warm welcome of their Senate.

[00:40:04] Senator Durant, the senator from Stafford. Madam President, I rise for an introduction. - The Senator may continue. - Madam President, I'm proud to recognize the Virginia Federation of Republican Women, if you would all like to stand.

[00:40:21] There we go. Wonderful. Madam President, this is an organization with a long and very respected history of leadership, service, and real civic involvement in our commonwealth. For decades, the women of the Virginia of Republican women have taken the forefront of grassroots and organization, policy education, and voter outreach.

[00:40:49] The dedication they showed to conservative principles and fiscal responsibility and accountable government has helped stage public discourse and strengthen citizen participation all across Virginia. The Virginia Federation of Public Women exemplifies what it means to be engaged, informed, committed to the future of our state. Their work ensures that the voices of Virginia families and communities are heard and respected in the public square.

[00:41:18] Please join me in extending a very warm welcome and sincere appreciation to the members of the Virginia Federation of Public Women for their service and your leadership. Thank you for coming. Thank you all for coming and Senator mentioned civic involvement and she talked about grassroots engagement and that it's work.

[00:41:42] all good things take work in fact it's more than work it's sacrifice and we're so glad that you've chosen to do it and you know as a immigrant to this great country just to see the work that people do to make sure that we're all involved it's just so awesome so thank you for being a part of doing that senators let

[00:42:06] us give them the warm welcome of their Senate senator Reeves the senator from orange thank you madam president i rise for an introduction the senator has the floor madam president in the gallery today wearing some biters and some without it's my pleasure to introduce the joint leadership council or the jlc otherwise known as they're a conglomerate of 28 veteran

[00:42:42] service organizations to include the vfw and the american legion as well as moa and a bunch of others they work to ensure that our veterans remain the best state our virginia remains the best state in the union for our military and our veterans population. Madam President, I'm truly honored to be able to work with them shoulder to shoulder to make sure that we are making sure that Virginia truly is the blessed place for our military and active force. If you would, Madam President, as a as a Marine, welcome the JLC. Welcome to you. How wonderful you all look. Thank

[00:43:17] you for serving your country. And I know that you continue to serve. Indeed, you're part of an organization that's service as a matter of fact oriented and if we welcomed the the women's group who are part of the civic engagement then certainly you're part of the other engagement that keeps our country strong thank you all for your continued support and sacrifice senators let us give them the warm

[00:43:46] welcome of their Senate or Jordan the senator from Isle of Wight thank you Madam President, I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[00:44:13] Madam President, today we have several members of the Virginia Nursery and Landscape Association visiting the Capitol today and I ask they would stand. They're joining us from all over the Commonwealth and they represent Virginia's garden centers, nursery growers, landscape designers, installation maintenance contractors, greenhouses, and green industry supplies so they keep the Commonwealth green. Their businesses support local jobs, help communities with green infrastructure, aid in stormwater management, and promote industry best practices that help Virginia green and growing. Please join me in welcoming the Virginia Nursery Landscape Association to

[00:44:47] the Virginia Senate. My fellow dirt throwers, the good dirt not the other kind of dirt, I love gardening and I tell you if I could do that full-time I would, but we're so glad that you are here to see your Senate in action and part of what you do is you provide jobs.

[00:45:10] that means you're helping to change lives and everybody knows that when you see flowers and the beauty of them it does help to change your outlook doesn't it thank you for coming senators let us give them the warm welcome of their senate the senator from northern fairfax senator boisco thank you madam president i um ask to request an excuse for my seat mate who is away

[00:45:46] on pressing and personal business. Thank you, Senator. The journal will so note. The Senator from Shenandoah. Senator French. Madam President, I'll rise for an introduction. The Senator may continue. Madam President, I noticed in a gallery day we have a good friend of this chamber, a past member, Jill Vogel, and a wonderful friend of mine, and she's worked tirelessly for this state,

[00:46:21] and it would not be good if we didn't recognize Jill. Why, Senator, are you there? you could have had privileges to the floor please stand please stand we're so we will post haste somebody will come get you so glad to see you thank you for

[00:47:01] coming resolutions petitions and bills are in order hearing none the next order

[00:47:22] of business is the election of pages of the Senate for the 2026 session my how

[00:48:03] beautiful you look. Sarah recognizes the Senator from Eastern Fairfax, Senator Surovell. Thank You Madam President and good afternoon. Good afternoon sir. Madam President, I would like to place the nomination for pages of the Senate the following names. First of all from the 1st District, Oliver Moore Holtzman of Shenandoah. From the 3rd District, Lauren Allen Phillips of Roanoke. The 5th

[00:48:42] District, Carly Rose Knox of Virginia Beach. From the 8th District, Aidan Thomas moss of lynchburg from the 10th district aubrey nina toller of hanover from the 12th district ansel asher eastman of chesterfield from the 13th district raquel diane riceweber of dinwiddie from the 14th district edwin august shields cot camp of richmond from the 17th district gavin

[00:49:22] tyler asbel of suffolk from the 19th district evan feld of virginia beach from the 21st district kenley irene moser of norfolk from the 22nd district hikmat uman of virginia beach from the 26th district caroline elizabeth shoemaker of williamsburg from the 27th district chance mel

[00:49:54] salt of stafford from the 30th district neela saravana kumar of prince william from the 31st district madison michelle nestor of loud from the 32nd district sophia joy fowler virginia beach from the 33rd district carter james barry of fairfax the 36th district vice nevi cy lachna of fairfax got that all right good and uh from the 37th district eugene

[00:50:34] xavier shelton of fairfax here now recognizes senator locke the senator from hampton madam president i second the nomination there recognizes now the senator from hanover senator thank you madam president madam president i move the nominations be closed without objection the

[00:51:13] nominations are closed all in favor then of the nominees named for pages will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote of all the senators voted does any senator desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 38 no zero ayes 38 no zero those

[00:51:44] nominated are now duly elected pages of the senate for the 2026 session congratulations chair now requests announcements of page appointments therefore chair now recognizes

[00:52:21] the senator from portsmouth senator lucas madam president i wish to announce the appointment of davion jeremiah harris of portsmouth as a page of the senate thank the senator chair recognizes is now Senator from Eastern Fairfax County.

[00:52:44] Senator Sauroville. - Thank you, Madam President. I wish to announce the appointment of Jackson West Taylor of Alexandria, that we like to think of Fairfax County as page of the Senate. - Thank the Senator, Chair. Also recognizes Senator McDougall as Senator from Hanover.

[00:53:01] - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I wish to announce the appointment of Claire Evelyn Donahue of Essex as a page of the Senate. - Thank the Senator. Again, Chair recognizes Senator Locke, Senator from Hampton, Madam President, I wish to announce the appointment of Maven Morwina Lackey of Hampton as a page of the Senate. Chair recognizes Senator Obenshain, Senator from Rockingham, Madam President, I wish to announce the appointment of Olivia Marguerite Holtzman Vogel as a page of

[00:53:37] the Senate. On behalf of our Lieutenant Governor-elect Senator Hashmi, I take it to appoint the announcement of Olivia Ryan Schmidt-Cousins of Richmond as page of the Senate.

[00:54:15] Again, Senator Locke, the senator from Hampton. Madam President, the clerk has advised me that the following pages have been appointed pursuant to the rules of the Senate. Courtney Ann Asell of

Nottoway, Max Callum Davis of Charlottesville, azalea davis lehman of chesterfield anne francis miller of richmond evelyn rose nazarino of

[00:54:46] fairfax and nicholas christopher perkarski of fairfax welcome pages to your senate

[00:55:01] please join me senators and i believe now uh you will begin to proceed to exit the senate

[00:55:26] For Sarahville, the senator is recognized for the purposes of a motion.

[00:56:12] Yeah, an overdue motion. Madam President, I've moved to extend the privileges of the floor to a certain distinguished person who's been, somehow got in here early. The question is, shall the rules be suspended and the privileges of the floor granted to a distinguished person?

[00:56:30] All in favor of the motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? I see no red lights. - Clerk will close the roll.

[00:56:48] - Ayes 38, noes zero. - Ayes 38, noes zero. The rules are suspended. The privileges of the floor are granted. Chair recognizes the Senator for the purposes of presenting the distinguished guests.

[00:57:08] - Thought McDougal was gonna do this, but ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, hope you join us in welcoming our former colleague we've already said hi to once today, who has decided to revisit us, I guess, to watch a kid and a cousin get sworn in. Our former Senator, who we all love, Jill Holtzman-Vogel. Thank you, Senator. Welcome. The Senate has already received a message from the

[00:57:46] House, and therefore, in the form of a resolution, and being procedural, the resolution will be taken up for immediate consideration. The clerk will report the resolution. House Joint Resolution Number 31, establishing an inaugural committee. Resolved by the House of Delegates, the Senate concurring that an inaugural committee be established the committee shall be composed of eight members of the Senate one of whom shall be the president pro temporee of the Senate and the remainder of whom shall be appointed by

[00:58:25] the president pro temporee of the Senate and 12 members of the house one of whom shall be the speaker of the House of Delegates and the remainder of whom shall be appointed by the speaker of the House of Delegates the committee shall make suitable plans and arrangements for the reception and induction into the respective offices of the governor-elect, the lieutenant governor-elect, and the attorney general-elect. Again, Senator Suravelle. Madam President, move the motion be the resolution be agreed to. The question is, shall the resolution be

[00:59:02] agreed to? All in favor of agreeing to the resolution will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The resolution is agreed to. The senator from From Eastern Fairfax County, Senator Cereville will inform the House of Delegates of the action of the Senate.

[00:59:21] The chair now recognizes Senator Lucas, Senator from Portsmouth.

[00:59:47] I would like to announce that the following have been named pursuant to H.J.R. 31 to serve as the inaugural committee on the part of the Senate.

[01:00:15] Myself as President Pro Tem, R. Cree Deeds, Mark D. Obenshain, Mamie E. Locke, Ryan T. mcdougall richard h stewart david does w marston and scott a cerebral we thank the senator the

[01:00:42] clerk will call the calendar senate calendar for thursday january 15 2026 regular calendar house joint resolutions on second reading house joint resolution one proposing amendment to the

constitution of virginia by adding an art in in article one a section numbered 11-a relating to

[01:01:13] to fundamental right to reproductive freedom. House Joint Resolution 2, proposing an amendment to Section 1 of Article 2 of the Constitution of Virginia, qualification of voters and the right to vote, persons not entitled to vote.

[01:01:37] House Joint Resolution 3, proposing an amendment to Section 15-A of Article 1 of the Constitution of Virginia relating to marriage between two adult persons, repeal of same-sex marriage prohibition, Confirmative Rights to Marry. House Joint Resolution 4. Proposing an amendment to Section 6 of Article 2 of the Constitution of Virginia and proposing an amendment to the Constitution of Virginia by adding in the schedule a Section Number 6 relating to apportionment Congressional District's limited authority of the General Assembly to modify.

[01:02:15] regular calendar senate joint resolutions on second reading senate joint resolution one proposing an amendment to the constitution of virginia by adding an article one a section number 11-a relating to fundamental right to reproductive freedom reported from the committee on privileges and elections and there is two floor amendment there are two floor amendments i'm sorry senator boisco the senator from northern fairfax thank you madam president i move the reading of

[01:02:55] bill be waived the bill or the amendment we're we have to deal with the floor amendments i see

[01:03:10] chair calls on senator durant the senator from stafford thank you madam president speaking to the amendment the senator may continue oh we need to wait still a little rusty sorry they're waving

[01:03:43] at me yes move to wave the reading the question is shall the reading of the durant floor amendment be waived. Those in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:03:59] The reading of the floor amendment is waived. Senator Durant. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to this amendment and to all of our friends on both sides, and we debated this issue on parental rights last year, and we certainly started heartfelt debate from both sides of our friends and it's I know it's coming from a place that I do feel is a genuine and heartfelt that's really is worth acknowledging I I would just ask that we take into consideration when it comes to parental rights a few things why why

[01:04:38] it is so important to never forget it parental involvement is it really truly is about protecting minors it is not about restricting them and there are some very very good reasons why we reflect that outside of this issue but You heard me speak about this last year.

[01:04:55] There's really nothing that we can do with our children that don't require authorization. Some of these kids come for a field trip. They have to have their parents' permission. If they get hurt at school, if they get banged up at recess or on the sports field, we have already given authorization whether or not they can get some medication.

[01:05:14] There are reasons behind that because parents are the only ones that really know that child. They're the only ones that understand what's appropriate and what's right. We all know that, many of us are parents. This really is about protecting and preserving the trust that is already established between parents and the healthcare system, and between all of us, in education, you name it.

[01:05:42] It really balances that responsibility. And if we have this inconsistency that is starting to brew up in our legal system between parental rights and how that is continued to be honored and respected, except here, We've got a really big problem.

[01:06:02] I remind you that in this last year, and I know some of you kind of questioned whether it was valid, it truly is valid. We've had instances where parents were not involved and it was only those in the school system or otherwise.

[01:06:18] And there can be some nefarious actors involved in some of these young ladies' lives that are seeking to get an abortion for reasons that are nefarious. I think it is incumbent upon us to never walk away from what is probably the most core valuable part of what we do as parents is to always ensure that we are responsible for their health, their well-being and their care and their safety.

[01:06:50] That's why I really implore each one of my friends on the other side that we respect that and that we pass this amendment. Thank you, Madam President. For what purpose does the Senator from Northern Fairfax rise?

[01:07:09] Thank you, Madam President. to speak to the amendment the senator has the floor thank you madam president um we i appreciate the senator from stafford acknowledging that there are there are really strong opinions and feelings very personal some of us have and certainly this debate should be be discussed with grace and uh sensitivity i will point out um the the senator made reference to uh something happened And at school, I would like to say that, and we discussed this in the committee yesterday,

[01:07:44] the investigation in Fairfax County that she's referring to showed that there were no accusations that were based in fact. That was not an accurate accusation. So I'd like to clarify that. Secondly, I would like to remind the body that we have already passed this constitutional amendment once.

[01:08:04] It is required to stay in exactly the same frame, no changes in the law, in the language at all, and it will go before the voters. But thirdly, I would just like to point out, you know, this amendment does not address Virginia's laws around parental consent.

[01:08:24] We have laws on the books. They will still be there. We are not asking to repeal them. This constitutional amendment is about preserving the freedom for individuals to make these most personal decisions about their reproductive health between themselves and their medical provider.

[01:08:47] We've seen in other parts of the country horror stories. And with that, I move that we, with the recommendation that we reject the amendment. I thank you for your time. The senator from Colonial Heights, Senator Sturman.

[01:09:09] Madam President, speaking to the floor amendment. The senator has a floor. Madam President, we do have laws on the books in Virginia that require parental consent for a minor to get an abortion. We all have laws in the books that also provide exceptions that a minor can even go to a judge if she is unable to get parental consent.

[01:09:32] But, you know, nine out of 10 Virginians agree that parents should have a role in an extraordinarily important medical decision like that involving one of their children when they are a minor.

[01:09:48] And what this proposed constitutional amendment says, it says that every individual has a fundamental right to reproductive freedom. And by saying every individual, that necessarily is going to

include minors. And if we amend the Virginia Constitution, that is going to supersede and overrule laws that we have in conflict with that, like the parental consent laws that are on the books in Virginia.

[01:10:16] And so the senator from Stafford has introduced a short and very simple clarification in her floor amendment that all it says is that notwithstanding the above, the Commonwealth's parental consent laws shall remain in effect and the Commonwealth may regulate the provision of abortion care and gender affirming care to minors.

[01:10:37] And so it maintains the status quo as we currently have it. And as I think the vast majority of Virginians agree is good that parents are involved in these very important decisions involving their children.

[01:10:54] And so we hear a lot on this issue of abortion that politicians shouldn't be getting involved in decisions between women and their doctors. But what this reproductive rights, so-called reproductive rights constitutional amendment does, is it's essentially putting this body, politicians, between kids and their parents.

[01:11:19] And that's not right. And so I hope it would be the will of the body to adopt the Durant floor amendment. Senator Favola. The senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:11:35] I rise to speak to the amendment. The senator may continue. - Thank you, Madam President. I would encourage the body to not adopt the amendment. I understand the patron may be well-intentioned, but there is nothing in our proposed constitutional amendment language that would override the parental consent laws that are currently on our books.

[01:11:59] And I just remind the body that we have, in many instances, in a bipartisan fashion, voted for laws to protect our children and to ensure that the best interest of the child is always put first and foremost.

[01:12:15] We do have cases where the parents and their involvement in a decision, a medical decision, or even an abortion decision, would not act in the best interest of the child. We have situations where there's incest, we have situations where there's been family sexual abuse, And in those situations, a child can petition the court and a case has to be made for the judge to determine what's in the best interest of the child.

[01:12:48] And that will remain. So I do not see a need for this amendment and I would encourage the body to vote no. Thank you, Madam President. The senator from Rockingham.

[01:13:06] Senator Obenshain. Madam President, speaking to the amendment very briefly. The senator has a floor. The Senator from Stafford and the Senator from Colonial Heights are completely right.

[01:13:23] And while I respect the support for or at least the acknowledgement of our parental involvement statute by the Senator from Arlington, I would point out that this really does, this amendment does affect a fundamental change, and fundamental is the key word, right, you know, I know this has been cast as simply a constitutional codification of Roe versus Wade.

[01:13:55] And if that was what this did, I think that the debate would be much shorter, much easier. We all know what Roe v. Wade did, the Supreme Court has clearly defined the limits of the ability of states to apply restrictions on abortion rights.

[01:14:15] The Supreme Court has basically said that states have to apply, or that the courts have to apply a rational basis test to any restrictions on abortion, that they have to be reasonably related to an important state interest.

[01:14:31] this does what this constitutional amendment does without the language that's been proposed by the center from Stafford is it turns this into a fundamental right and fundamental right is it is important constitutional language and I know that people feel very strongly about abortion rights but but fundamental is used colloquially in one sense but constitutionally in another and when it is embedded in the Constitution this becomes a fundamental right the courts will apply a strict scrutiny test and a strict scrutiny test

[01:15:08] has been applied to parental notification and parental involvement laws across the country in other states and courts have held that when a strict scrutiny test is applied that parental consent parental notification parental involvement laws fail under that constitutional analysis. So make no mistake about it. As written, this constitutional amendment is not simply a codification of Roe versus Wade. It goes much farther. It presents an engraved

[01:15:43] invitation who anybody who wants to challenge any restriction on abortions to go to court and mount a constitutional challenge seeking to have those reasonable those restrictions that courts have repeatedly held to be reasonable restrictions like the widely supported parental involvement statutes we have here in Virginia it is an engraved invitation for them to have them declared unconstitutional if this passes mark my words those reasonable restrictions that many of us I believe on both sides the aisle believe are reasonable those will be struck down by the courts

[01:16:22] Senator Souravelle the senator from Eastern Fairfax County the senator has a floor a minute president and I appreciate that the academic conversation we're having here the reality is if we were to pass this amendment it basically kills this amendment for another two years and this is really just a delay tactic and this is a debate that needed to happen last year it was had last year it was resolved last year having it now is just an effort to basically kill the amendment because we have to pass it in

[01:16:53] identical form. And I think we all know we're going to vote on this. And Madam President, I hope we could focus on what this is really trying to do as opposed to the substance because this would not affect any amendment that would actually pass or become law. It would just kill it. So that's really what we're doing today by having this debate. Hope we'd all vote no.

[01:17:11] We have a motion on the floor from Senator Boisco.

[01:17:33] We have a motion on the floor from her. We had to take a motion. I know, but she made a motion, and so I'm just, I'm going to ask. If she'll withdraw.

[01:17:46] The question is, shall the Durant floor amendment, yeah, yeah.

[01:18:15] The question is, shall the Durant floor amendment be agreed to? Those in favor will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. No. This shall be a recorded vote.

[01:18:49] Question is, shall the Durant floor amendment be agreed to? Those in favor will record their votes. Aye, those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Does any senator desire to change their vote?

[01:19:06] The clerk will close the roll. - Ayes 19, noes 20. - Ayes 19, noes 20. The floor amendment is not agreed to.

[01:19:29] We have another floor amendment, the Jordan floor amendment. - Senator, chair calls on. Senator Jordan, a senator from Isle of Wight.

[01:19:45] - Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the floor amendment. - The senator has the floor. What? - Oh, I'm sorry. I'd first like to waive reading of the floor amendment. - By the time I get the hang of it again, I'll be out.

[01:20:03] Question is, shall the reading of the Jordan floor amendment be waived? Those in favor will say aye. Those opposed, no. The reading of the Jordan floor amendment is waived. Senator Jordan. - Thank you, Madam President.

[01:20:19] This amendment we talked about last year and I know that some of my colleagues on the other side of the aisle says this would kill the total amendment going forward. But sometimes in this body, I don't think that we can let getting things right be in the way of delaying something, not killing something. This amendment is just very simple, clear, narrow.

[01:20:36] I think it's rooted in principle and I think it's just plain common sense, to be honest. When a child is born alive, they will be provided medical care, just as if every other person sitting in this chamber would be entitled to.

[01:20:52] Regardless of where I know that each of our sides of the aisle stand on the broader debate of this bill, I think it addresses one very key and critical moment. When a child is actually born alive, they should be provided life-saving medical care.

[01:21:07] To me, I think it's very crystal clear of the conundrum we have, that we have to address medical ethics. We need to provide guidance for medical providers. And I truly believe that nobody should be denied care if a newborn is born alive.

[01:21:23] I hope or I thought when I came to this body nine years ago that something that was so simple as an infant being born alive would be a partisan talking point or that I'd have to stand before you today to even address offering this four amendments. But we stand here having that conversation, not to talk about politics or ideology, but if this delays something, we can get this right.

[01:21:51] I would implore my friends on the other side of the aisle to take a true and honest look at this floor amendment, think about the clarity it could provide, and support this floor amendment. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:22:09] - The question is, shall the Jordan floor amendment be-- - Madam President. - Ah, Senator Boiesko. Thank you, Madam President. I'd just like to level set this conversation. Senator has the floor. To the amendment, thank you.

[01:22:27] There's a standard of care that our medical professionals follow and are required by oath that they take. This amendment is a fear tactic. That is not how abortion works.

[01:22:44] The only time, and currently in our law right now, Virginia has already allowed, under our current law, pregnancy that goes terribly wrong during the third trimester, terribly wrong.

[01:23:07] The patient's health is at serious risk. The pregnancy cannot survive. Those are the times when someone has an abortion later in the pregnancy.

[01:23:22] What my good friend just talked about does not happen. It is a scare tactic. It is meant to make people afraid. It is a misrepresentation of what medical providers do. And around the country, Madam President, we are seeing women dying on gurneys because doctors are afraid to perform life-saving abortion care for people who are dying and will not be able to survive unless that.

[01:23:53] I had a very serious life-threatening illness in the eighth month of my pregnancy, the end of the seventh month. I know what it's like to have a doctor look at you and say, if we don't do something, you're going to die. I was very fortunate that my baby now is 28 and married to her wife, but we are not doctors in this room. We are not going to be sitting in the

[01:24:23] hospital with these patients. We are here to provide the opportunity for doctors and their patients to make the best decisions for the patient and put the patient first.

[01:24:41] I would ask that the body reject this amendment and the voters will get to make the final decision on a referendum. I ask everybody to vote no. Senator for Prince Edward. Senator Cyphers.

[01:25:03] Thank you, Madam President. I would just like to point out the way that I read this. the senator has the floor sorry madam president speaking of the resolution um the the way that i read this it's the the permission for third trimester abortions is not limited to medical emergencies it's also if in the judgment excuse me of a physician that the the mother's uh mental health could be um somehow uh compromised or jeopardized and madam president the the doctors that are performing these procedures aren't always trained mental health professionals so

[01:25:43] i don't think it's just a scare tactic i think it's a legitimate concern and the goal here is just to make sure that if a doctor does make a mistake and that there's a human being born alive that they receive the decency of of care i just wanted to clarify that there are more things here than medical emergencies that could create this situation thank you again senator jordan the the senator from Isle of Wight. Thank you, Madam President. I just wanted to have a final word and

[01:26:21] I've been in this body a long time and it is never. Senator has the floor. I'm sorry. Thank you, Madam President. It's never my intention to offer a scare tactic and a lot of this amendment is actually rooted in words that we heard just a couple years ago and I think that was a clarity that led me to file this and I'm just going to read those back because this is what was exactly shared just a few short years ago. If a mother is in labor, I can tell you exactly what would happen.

[01:26:54] The infant would be delivered. The infant would be kept comfortable. The infant would be resuscitated if that's what the mother and the family desired, if. And then a discussion would ensue between the physicians and the mother. I don't intend to send this body to ever offer scare tactics. I intend to be purposeful in the work that I do and these are the exact words of one of our former colleagues and so I ask that you would consider that that was what was clearly stated just a few short years ago in this Commonwealth that would be

[01:27:31] the process thank you madam president the question is shall the Jordan floor amendment be agreed to those in favor will say aye those opposed no this will a recorded vote. Those in favor of the Jordan Amendment will please signify aye.

[01:28:00] Those opposed, no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Of all the Senators voted, does any Senator wish to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 19,

[01:28:16] noes 20. Ayes 19, noes 20. The Jordan Amendment fails. Senator Boyesco. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall the resolution be engrossed and advanced to its third reading?

[01:28:53] Those in favor will say aye. Those opposed, no. The resolution is engrossed and advanced to its third reading. Senate Joint Resolution 2, proposing an amendment on Section 1 of Article 2 of the Constitution of Virginia, relating to qualification of voters and the right to vote, persons not entitled to vote. Reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections, and there are four

[01:29:24] floor amendments. Senator McDougall, the senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I would ask that we take the floor amendments in a block and waive the reading. Question is, shall all floor amendments in the block, the reading of same be waived? Those in favor will say aye. Those opposed, no. The

[01:30:03] floor amendments in the block, the reading has been waived. Senator McDougall. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, speaking to the The Senator has a floor. Madam President, this is pretty straightforward. And we had this conversation last year, I believe it's the Senator from Fairfax indicated.

[01:30:21] And these were amendments that were proposed last year as well. In relation to whether individuals who have been convicted of felonies should have the restitution, should have their rights to be reinstated, I think there is some agreement between Republicans and Democrats.

[01:30:39] that agreement comes in certain areas. One, and this is reflected in floor amendment number one, if it's a nonviolent felony, then their rights should be restored. Think that we can all agree, people make mistakes, we have penalties for those mistakes, and we try to make sure that our victims are made whole, but once you have done that, then your rights be restored.

[01:31:06] So floor amendment number one reflects where I think this entire body could come to an agreement that things like drug crimes, things like property crimes, those that are nonviolent rights could be restored.

[01:31:22] Madam President, the Second Amendment deals with victims. As we look at the criminal justice system, it's not just one sided. It's not just from the focus of the rights of the individual who was charged or in this situation who has been convicted it is also the rights of the victims and in some criminal cases victims have been harmed they have received physical harm they've received emotional harm and they might have expenses and losses

[01:31:59] individually that they're out of madam president the second amendment would require before those rights are restored that the victim be made whole that if they were physically harmed that the defendant would pay the restitution pay their medical bills if property was stolen or embezzled that that individual would pay for that property that was stolen or embezzled now

[01:32:30] Now, Madam President, I've heard some argue where there's still the ability to collect what that victim has lost down the road. And Madam President, there could be a process to do that. But in this

situation, we're talking about restoring someone's rights, but we are not making sure that victims are made whole before that happens.

[01:32:56] so as we look at the criminal justice system and the balance victims have to play a role in that and we can all agree that people should have rights restored for non-violent offenses but we believe that victims should also be made whole that their rights should be protected and they should not have to put things out of pocket they should not have to face bankruptcy they should not have to face loss that they should be taken care of initially.

[01:33:29] Madam President, the other two amendments are more structural in the program in the bill. The main ones are the first two. So this is an area where Republicans and Democrats can come to an agreement, can agree on a path forward, but that path is one that would require victims to be made whole and one that would focus on individuals convicted of non-violent offenses while making specific decisions on individuals that were convicted of violent offenses thank you madam president

[01:34:02] the senator from eastern fairfax county senator surovell uh speaking to the amendment the senator may continue thank you madam president you know i was looking at this amendment and i was almost tempted to vote for it because i was thinking through it that if we actually were to pass this then um president trump would have to go on his hands and knees to abigail spamberger to get his right to vote back if he decided to move to virginia but then i thought you know even president trump deserves not to have to do that so i still think we ought to reject this amendment for the reasons i talked about before if we pass this it'll actually kill the amendment

[01:34:41] senator lock the senator from hampton speaking to the amendment senator may continue madam President I asked my colleagues to vote no on the amendment amendments primarily for reasons that have been stated on the previous amendment being that this is simply designed to torpedo this amendment we know the process constitutional amendments must be passed in the exact same form in for two sessions with an

[01:35:16] intervening election we cannot change the language in this amendment if we do that simply makes this amendment null and void and we know that that's the reason for these amendments to simply kill it um and i want to draw your attention specifically to amendment number four um if we want to do that that's the process as it currently exists if i wanted that process i never would have put the amendment in in the first place so i would ask

[01:35:47] that we vote no on these amendments thank you madam president question is shall the mcdougall floor amendment be agreed to those in favor will say aye those opposed no this will be recorded those in favor of the mcdougall amendment will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted does any senator desire to change their vote

[01:36:16] the clerk will close the roll yeah as 19 knows 20. ice 19 knows 20. the mcdougall amendment fails Senator Locke. Madam President, I move that SJ2 be engrossed in advance to its third reading.

[01:36:38] The question is, shall the resolution now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? Those in favor will say aye. Those opposed, no. The resolution is engrossed in advance to its third reading. Senate Joint Resolution 3, proposing an amendment to Section 15-A of Article 1 of the Constitution of Virginia relating to marriage between two adult persons, repeal of the same-sex marriage prohibition and affirmative right to marry reported from the

[01:37:12] committee on privileges and elections senator i've been the senator from alexandria thank you madam president i moved that we engrossed in advance senate joint resolution three to its third constitutional reading the question is shall the resolution be engrossed in advance to its third uh senator jordan the senator from olive white thank you madam president i had submitted a floor amendment I don't have a floor amendment.

[01:37:46] We have one for you, H.J.R. Okay, I'll withdraw that, Madam President. Madam President, can I ask this to go by temporarily?

[01:38:08] I'm sorry. Without objection, I ask, could this go by temporarily? Without objection, Senate Joint Resolution 3 goes by temporarily. Memorial Resolutions.

[01:38:26] Senator Saraville, the senator from Eastern Fairfax County. Madam President, I move the Memorial Resolutions on pages 3 through 4, S.J.R. 4 through S.J.R. 35, Be considered in the block in the usual manner, waiving the reading of the resolutions thereof, with the understanding that any senator desiring the resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution.

[01:38:46] The question is, how the memorial resolutions on pages 3 and 4,

[01:39:46] Senate Joint Resolution 4 through Senate Joint Resolution 35, be considered in the block in the usual manner, waiving the reading of the resolutions thereof, with the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution to be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the title of the resolution all in favor of the motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the resolutions are before us in the block the clerk will now read the title of the resolutions senate joint resolution four

[01:40:25] Celebrating the life of Gloria Olderog Webb. Senate Joint Resolution 6. Celebrating the life of John Michael DeTroiner, M.D. Senate Joint Resolution 13.

[01:40:41] Celebrating the life of Dana Fraley Gray. Senate Joint Resolution 14. Celebrating the life of Norman Graydon Landberg. Senate Joint Resolution 16. Celebrating the life of Brenda Moselle Barnett Lawson.

[01:41:01] Senate Joint Resolution 17, celebrating the life of James Wade Gilley, Sr., Ph.D. Senate Joint Resolution 24, celebrating the life of John S. Cheadle. Senate Joint Resolution 35, celebrating the life of Palmer Leslie Griffith, Jr.

[01:41:26] For what purpose does the senator? The resolutions will be agreed to in the usual manner. All in favor of agreeing to the memorial resolutions, please rise.

[01:41:52] The resolutions are agreed to. - Commending resolution. - Senator Saraville. - Madam President, I move the commanding resolutions on pages four through six, SJR five through SR two, be considered in the block by voice vote, waiving the reading of the resolutions of the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution to be removed from the block.

[01:42:16] We'll do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. - The question is, shall the commanding resolutions on pages four through six, Senate joint resolution five through Senate resolution to be considered in the block by voice vote, waiving the reading of the resolutions with the understanding

that any senator desiring a resolution to be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the title, the number of the resolution.

[01:42:52] All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Those opposed, no, the ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The resolutions are before us in the block. Clerk will now read the number of the resolution. Senate Joint Resolutions 5, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 15, 18, 20, 25, 29, 30, 33, 34, Senate Resolution 1, 2.

[01:43:27] Question is, shall the resolutions be agreed to? All in favor of agreeing to the resolutions will say aye.

[01:43:43] Those opposed no, the ayes have it. The resolutions are agreed to.

[01:44:17] As we consider certain procedures, the Senate will be temporarily at ease. Bathroom break.

[01:57:36] Returning to page 3, SJR 3, we have one floor amendment.

[02:01:02] The senator from Isle of Wight. Senator Jordan. Thank you, Madam President. I would move to waive the reading of the floor amendment.

[02:01:19] The question is, shall the reading of the Jordan floor amendment be waived? Those in favor will say aye. Those opposed, no. The reading of the floor amendment is waived. Senator Jordan.

[02:01:35] - Thank you, Madam President. The floor amendment I've offered today is truly just to provide clarity. I know the Supreme Court has ruled on this issue, so I don't believe that there's any rush and I think it's important in this body we at least attempt to get things right, to protect all people. So what this amendment does, it's just very, very clear, that no clergy member will be compelled to perform ceremonies conflict with their sincerely held religious beliefs.

[02:01:58] That would include ministers, priests, rabbis, moms, pastors, bishops, elders, and any other religious leader authorized for marriages within their faith traditions. I would ask my colleagues to support the floor amendment. Thank you, Madam President. The question is, Senator Evan, the senator from Alexandria. Yes, speaking to the floor amendment. The senator has a floor. I think that the senator from the aisle white is a little confused, because this constitutional amendment that's before us is about the Commonwealth and

[02:02:36] its political subdivisions, meaning government and civil marriage, and her floor amendment is about holy matrimony, a religious institution. The bill or the resolution says the Commonwealth and its political subdivisions shall not deny the issuance of a marriage license to adult persons seeking a lawful marriage, and further that the Commonwealth and its political subdivisions shall recognize any lawful marriage. This amendment could have been offered last year, it was not. The patron is a member of the Privileges and Elections Committee, it could have been offered in that committee, it was not. But

[02:03:16] I just want to explain that there, or make it clear, that in my research I've never been able to find an instance where a religious celebrant was ordered to offer the religious ceremony of holy matrimony, the First Amendment would preclude that.

[02:03:34] Just like we don't have Catholic priests forced to offer holy matrimony to divorce people or have rabbis under the law forced to undertake communion, it just doesn't happen. It's a nothing burger. It's irrelevant to this particular amendment.

[02:03:51] And further, I would assure the senator from the Isle of White, that the Code of Virginia, in fact, specifies that religious celebrants cannot be compelled to administer a marriage to anyone.

[02:04:07] So with that, I would ask that we vote no on this amendment. And finally, I would note that the delegate from Eastern Prince William down the hall noted last year on the House floor that he's never been compelled or attempted to be compelled to celebrate any marriage since the Oberfeld decision like the other religious celebrants around this commonwealth.

[02:04:27] And with that, again, I ask that we vote no. - Question is, shall the Jordan amendment, floor amendment, be agreed to? Those in favor will say aye.

[02:04:44] Those opposed, no. - No. - This will be a recorded vote. Shall the Jordan floor amendment be agreed to? Those in favor will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[02:05:00] Does any senator desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 19, noes 20. Ayes 19, noes 20. The Jordan Amendment is not accepted. Senator Evan.

[02:05:18] Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall the bill now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? Those in favor will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bill is engrossed in advance to its third reading.

[02:05:41] The senator from Senator Surrillville.

[02:06:00] Just don't call me Sazlaw. That will be tomorrow. Got it. I'm sure he'll appreciate that. Madam Clerk, Ingrid the Clerk, does that complete today's calendar? Yes, sir.

[02:06:16] Excellent. Is there any other business to come before the Senate? Senator Locke, the senator from Hampton. Madam President, I rise on a point of personal privilege.

[02:06:32] The senator may continue. Madam President, today, January 15, 2026, have been dr martin luther king jr's 97th birthday many of us on this floor know his story as of being a noted civil rights leader and activists being gunned down on april 4 1968 on a hotel balcony in memphis tennessee at the age of 39. king's birthday was finally approved as a federal holiday in 1983 and all 50 states made it a state government holiday by 2000. the king holiday is marked every year on the third monday in january we celebrate that holiday this year on january 19th

[02:07:11] but today we mark the 97th year of his birth in atlanta georgia dr king fought for unity and justice yet in an era of blatant racism voter suppression and political opportunism let us be mindful of his warning that quote nothing in all the world is more dangerous than sincere ignorance and conscientious stupidity." Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.'s teachings called for unity among marginalized communities and demanded accountability from those who enabled injustice. Yet, as we

[02:07:45] examine the current socio-political landscape, we must ask, how would Dr. King view the state of America today? Would he be heartened by the progress made or would he find himself dismayed by the contradictions, compromises, and even betrayals among those he fought so hard to uplift.

[02:08:06] While there may be crowds still marching against discrimination and inequality, echoing the movements of the past, the challenges today demand more than just marching. They require strategic action, cultural accountability, and a rejection of complacency that allows injustice to fester. How do we

respond to moves of erasing and sanitizing history to suit one's purpose for example altering the national park service calendar removing mlk day and juneteenth from the days when interest fees are waived at national parks but adding a new

[02:08:45] free day to include the president's birthday which coincides with flag day and other days we're fully aware that the context of these changes is part of a broader effort to roll back diversity equity and inclusion dr king's dream was not just about ending segregation it was about creating a society where all people not just black people were empowered united and unwilling to compromise their dignity for a short-term gain as we reflect on the state of

[02:09:19] our community we must ask ourselves are we living up to that vision or are we in moments of convenience engaging in what dr king condemned as sincere ignorance and conscientious stupidity the answer to that question will determine whether we continue to move toward justice or whether we allow history to repeat itself madam president i ask that when we adjourn today we do so in honor and memory of the drum major for justice dr martin Luther king jr thank you

[02:09:55] senator senator ebon the senator from alexandria uh the senior senator from fairfax senator marsden Thank you Madam President. I rise for an announcement. The Senator has a floor. Thank you Madam President. As Chairman of the Senate Agriculture Conservation and Natural Resources Committee, I would like to remind each of you that tonight is the annual Virginia Agribusiness Council Legislative Appreciation Banquet at Main Street Station here in downtown Richmond.

[02:10:26] The event begins with a reception featuring vendors of Virginia's finest products at 5:30 p.m. Dinner starts at 7 and will be followed by a short program. For those of you who may not be aware of this event, it is always held on this first Thursday of session. Agriculture is Virginia's largest private sector industry, and the banquet is historically the largest event of its kind during the session.

[02:10:48] They expect around 1,200 attendees this year. You can reach out to me and I'll get you in touch with Brad Copenhaver if you haven't made arrangements to attend and It's going to be kind of crowded down there You might want to take an uber or a lyft or walk to get there But madam president. I just got back from an agriculture chairs conference in New Orleans, Louisiana Where I think so 30 some of our states were represented by ag chairs from States far west mostly but but from the Midwest and even a few from the from the south and you know I don't have much of an agricultural district I think I got 12 people growing tomatoes in the backyard but you come away with a respect for

[02:11:27] what these people go through the sacrifices they make the difficulty of the world that they live in that's ever-changing and so please support our own diverse agriculture community here in Virginia it is our it is our biggest thing in terms of business and show them your support for the sacrifices that they make every day. So thank you, Madam President. Give me a call if you haven't made arrangements to attend. I'll hook you up. Thank you. Senator Sorovelle.

[02:12:02] President Rice for an announcement. The senator has the floor. Ladies and gentlemen, I believe on Monday we're doing judicial elections, if I'm not mistaken, under the procedure resolution or maybe Tuesday. Tuesday, sir.

[02:12:18] Tuesday. Either way, courts committee meets on Monday, and I think we're planning on certifying any judges for re-election that day. If you have any concerns about judges who are up for re-election, you need to make sure you let somebody on the courts committee know. If you don't serve on

courts, if you're on courts, be ready to talk about it. I'm not aware of anybody right now who might be in jeopardy, but if there are, I'd also appreciate if you let me know so I can know in advance.

[02:12:41] So that's early next week. The senator from Stafford.

[02:12:58] Madam President, just speaking to a point of personal privilege. The Senator may continue. I was listening to my colleague on the side talking about Martin Luther King and it reminded me, Madam President, just a quote that's a favorite. I think you and I have discussed at times that in the end we remember not the words of our enemies but the silence of our friends.

[02:13:18] His legacy really does call us not just to admire justice but to stand for us especially when doing so is uncomfortable. Thank you very much, Madam President. Any other business?

[02:13:34] The clerk will announce any announcements on the desk. Today, Thursday, January 15th, the Committee on Transportation will meet 15 minutes after adjournment, Senate Room B, the GAB. The Education and Health Subcommittee on Public Education will meet 15 minutes after adjournment in Senate Room C, GAB.

[02:13:57] The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Education will not meet. Tomorrow, Friday, January 16th, the Committee on Rehabilitation and Social Services will not meet. The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Capital Outlay and Transportation will meet at 8 a.m. Senate Finance and Appropriations Room 13th Floor, GAB.

[02:14:19] The Democratic Caucus will meet 45 minutes before session in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol. The Republican Caucus will meet 30 minutes before session in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. Chair calls on Senator Lucas, the senator from Portsmouth.

[02:14:43] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 10 a.m. tomorrow. The question is, Madam President, and I also move that when we adjourn today that we do so in honor and memory of the Reverend Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr.

[02:15:04] Question is, shall the Senate adjourn until 10:00 a.m. tomorrow in memory of the Reverend Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr.? As many as are in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[02:15:20] The motion is agreed to. now stands adjourned in the memory of the Reverend Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

[02:15:27] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[02:18:43] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

